GRADE 5 ELA

Topic 5: Writing Skills and Composition

Question Bank • Common Core-aligned to W.5.1–W.5.9

150 multiple-choice questions

50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Includes randomized answer options and a verified answer key.

Student: _____ Date: _____

Easy Questions

1. Which sentence states an opinion?

A. An apple is a type of fruit.
B. The cafeteria serves lunch at noon.
C. School lunches should include more fresh fruit.
D. The lunch menu changed on Tuesday.

2. Which sentence best introduces a paragraph about caring for a pet?

A. The leash is beside the door.
B. Yesterday I saw a bird.
C. Pets need daily care to stay healthy and safe.
D. My dog has brown ears.

3. Which detail best supports the idea that exercise is healthy?

A. My shoes are blue.
B. Some people prefer rainy days.
C. Walking can strengthen the heart and muscles.
D. The park has three benches.

4. Which sentence best concludes a paragraph about planting a garden?

A. Seeds come in many shapes.
B. A shovel is a garden tool.
C. First, loosen the soil.
D. With care and patience, a small garden can thrive.

5. Which word best signals the next event in a story?

A. Unless
B. Because
C. Next
D. Although

6. Which word shows that one event happened afterward?

A. However
B. Instead
C. For example
D. Then

7. Which statement is an opinion?

A. A book has pages.
B. Every classroom should have a reading corner.
C. A classroom has desks.
D. The library opens at nine.

8. Which sentence is a fact?

A. Seven is a lucky number.
B. A week has seven days.
C. Weeks feel too long.
D. Monday is the best day.

9. Which source is most useful for learning about ocean animals?

A. A list of classroom rules
B. A nonfiction book about marine life
C. A menu from a restaurant
D. A fictional story about a robot

10. Why should a writer take notes while researching?

A. To record useful information for later writing
B. To avoid reading the source
C. To copy every page word for word
D. To make the report longer without adding facts

11. What is an outline used for?

A. Checking spelling only
B. Choosing the paper color
C. Organizing main ideas and supporting details
D. Replacing the final draft

12. What should a writer usually do when drafting?

A. Make every sentence perfect before continuing
B. Skip the topic and write random details
C. Get ideas down in an organized first version
D. Only check punctuation

13. What does revising mainly help a writer improve?

A. Ideas, organization, and clarity
B. The number of pages in a notebook
C. The shape of the letters
D. The color of the pencil

14. Which task is part of editing?

A. Adding a new main argument
B. Choosing a new research question
C. Correcting spelling and punctuation errors
D. Changing the whole topic without a reason

15. When should a writer proofread?

A. After making revisions and edits
B. Before thinking of a topic
C. Instead of writing a draft
D. Only when the paper has no paragraphs

16. Which sentence does not belong in a paragraph about healthy breakfasts?

A. My favorite movie is a comedy.
B. Eggs can provide protein.
C. Oatmeal provides energy for the morning.
D. Fruit adds vitamins to breakfast.

17. Which order makes the most sense for instructions on planting a seed?

A. Fill a pot with soil, plant the seed, then water it.
B. Plant the seed, harvest it, then find a pot.
C. Harvest the plant, plant the seed, then add soil.
D. Water the seed, harvest the plant, then fill a pot.

18. Which sentence punctuates dialogue correctly?

A. I found the map," said Tola.
B. "I found the map" said, Tola.
C. "I found the map", said Tola.
D. "I found the map," said Tola.

19. Which sentence is capitalized correctly?

A. On friday, we visited the national museum.
B. on Friday, we visited the National Museum.
C. On Friday, we visited the national museum.
D. On Friday, we visited the National Museum.

20. Which is a complete sentence?

A. Running through the hallway.
B. When the rain began.
C. The puppy slept beside the chair.
D. Because the puppy was tired.

21. Which sentence is correctly written?

A. The bell rang, and the students lined up.
B. The bell rang and, the students lined up.
C. The bell rang, the students lined up.
D. The bell rang the students lined up.

22. Which word best replaces "went" in "The turtle went across the path"?

A. did
B. got
C. crawled
D. made

23. Which sentence includes a sound detail?

A. The kettle whistled sharply in the quiet kitchen.
B. The kettle was purchased yesterday.
C. The kettle is beside the stove.
D. The kettle is made of metal.

24. Which detail best describes a story's setting?

A. The main character solves a puzzle.
B. The story teaches readers to be kind.
C. The hero learns to be brave.
D. The story begins in a small village during a storm.

25. Which detail best shows that a character is generous?

A. Mina counts the chairs in the room.
B. Mina shares her lunch with a classmate who forgot theirs.
C. Mina hides her lunch in a drawer.
D. Mina reads a sign twice.

26. Which sentence shows cause and effect?

A. The bus is yellow and large.
B. The driver wore a blue jacket.
C. The road and the bridge are nearby.
D. Because the road flooded, the bus took another route.

27. Which detail best supports the opinion that the school needs more trees?

A. Some trees lose leaves in autumn.
B. Trees can provide shade on the playground.
C. The playground has a gate.
D. The school has several classrooms.

28. If you are writing directions for younger students, what should you do?

A. Use unexplained technical terms.
B. Make every sentence as long as possible.
C. Leave out important steps.
D. Use clear steps and familiar words.

29. Which sentence is most appropriate for a school report?

A. The sun was, like, doing its thing.
B. Those little guys totally grew a lot.
C. The plants got super happy in the sun.
D. The experiment showed that sunlight helped the seedlings grow.

30. Which title best fits a report about how bees help plants?

A. The History of Bicycles
B. A Guide to Video Games
C. How Bees Help Plants Grow
D. My Favorite School Day

31. Which word signals a similarity?

A. Both
B. Unlike
C. However
D. Instead

32. Which word signals a difference?

A. Also
B. Unlike
C. Both
D. Similarly

33. Which sentence uses commas in a series correctly?

A. We packed water fruit, and sandwiches.
B. We packed water, fruit, and sandwiches.
C. We packed water, fruit and, sandwiches.
D. We packed, water, fruit and sandwiches.

34. Which verb makes the sentence more precise? “The horse ___ across the field.”

A. did
B. galloped
C. was
D. went

35. Why should a writer check who created a website?

A. To judge whether the information may be trustworthy
B. To find out whether the website uses bright colors
C. To make the report sound more complicated
D. To avoid checking the facts

36. Which action helps a writer avoid plagiarism?

A. Copy a paragraph without naming its source.
B. Put borrowed words in quotation marks and credit the source.
C. Change one word and claim the whole passage as your own.
D. Use facts from a source but hide where they came from.

37. What should a good summary include?

A. The writer's unrelated opinions
B. A new ending that was not in the text
C. The main ideas and important details
D. Every small detail in the same order

38. What should a conclusion usually do?

A. Bring the writing to a clear close
B. Add evidence that changes the topic
C. Introduce several unrelated topics
D. Repeat the first sentence exactly every time

39. Which ending best resolves a story about a lost dog being found?

A. The dog had four paws.
B. A leash hung by the door.
C. After a careful search, the family brought the dog home safely.
D. The family began searching at noon.

40. Which sentence is a clear claim?

A. Our school should start a recycling program.
B. Recycling bins are often blue.
C. Some students walk to school.
D. The hallway has two doors.

41. Which reason best supports a claim that students need daily reading time?

A. Reading logs can be printed on paper.
B. The classroom has twelve windows.
C. Some books have colorful covers.
D. Reading practice builds vocabulary and comprehension.

42. Which detail best helps readers picture a beach?

A. The beach is a place near water.
B. Warm sand slipped between my toes as waves rolled ashore.
C. A beach can appear on a map.
D. People visit beaches in many countries.

43. Which transition introduces an example?

A. Finally
B. Meanwhile
C. Nevertheless
D. For instance

44. Which transition best begins the last step in a process?

A. Finally
B. Instead
C. Although
D. Similarly

45. What is the most helpful peer comment?

A. This is bad.
B. Your main idea is clear; one more example could strengthen paragraph two.
C. Write more words, no matter what they say.
D. I like the color of your folder.

46. Why might a writer revise more than once?

A. Revision is only for adding pages.
B. A first draft can never contain ideas.
C. Writers must change every sentence even if it works.
D. Each revision can make the writing clearer and stronger.

47. Why should writers vary sentence beginnings and lengths?

A. To avoid using any punctuation.
B. To make writing smoother and more interesting to read.
C. To make the meaning harder to follow.
D. To make every sentence exactly the same length.

48. Which greeting is suitable for a formal letter to a school principal?

A. Hey, what's up?
B. Dear Principal Adeyemi,
C. Yo there!
D. Hi bestie!

49. Which detail belongs in a personal narrative about a memorable day?

A. What happened and how you felt during the day
B. Instructions for repairing a bicycle
C. A dictionary entry for the word “day”
D. A list of unrelated facts about planets

50. What is the best reason to make a final copy of a report?

A. To hide missing evidence
B. To replace the need for a conclusion
C. To avoid checking the facts
D. To present the finished work clearly and neatly

Medium Questions

1. Which claim is best supported by the reason that students can borrow books without paying?

A. Books are always more interesting than films.
B. The school should expand its library collection.
C. Every student enjoys every book.
D. Libraries should close during lunch.

2. Which evidence best supports the claim that bike helmets improve safety?

A. A helmet can come in several colors.
B. Some bicycles have baskets.
C. A rider prefers cycling in the morning.
D. A safety study found fewer serious head injuries among helmet users.

3. In an opinion essay, what is a counterargument?

A. A reason someone might disagree with the claim
B. The title of the essay
C. A detail that repeats the claim exactly
D. The final spelling check

4. What does a rebuttal do?

A. Lists every source alphabetically
B. Responds to an opposing argument with reasoning or evidence
C. Repeats the counterargument without answering it
D. Introduces an unrelated topic

5. Which order best organizes an opinion essay?

A. Claim, reasons with evidence, response to another view, conclusion
B. Three reasons without stating a position
C. List of sources, conclusion, claim, no reasons
D. Conclusion, unrelated story, title, claim

6. Which transition best shows a result? “The team practiced daily. ___, its passing improved.”

A. On the other hand
B. For example
C. As a result
D. At first

7. What is the main purpose of an informative report?

A. To convince readers to buy something
B. To hide the facts from the reader
C. To explain a topic clearly using accurate information
D. To tell an invented adventure only

8. Which source is most appropriate for a report on local rainfall records?

A. A fictional story about a flood
B. An advertisement for raincoats
C. An anonymous comment with no evidence
D. A government weather service's published records

9. Which note is best for a report on sea turtles?

A. Copy the entire article without quotation marks
B. Sea turtles lay eggs on sandy beaches; source: marine science article
C. Sea turtles are cool, I think, and maybe green
D. Use this fact somewhere but do not record its source

10. Which example best paraphrases a source while crediting it?

A. Wetlands absorb excess water during storms. (copied word for word with no credit)
B. The article explains that wetlands absorb excess water during storms (Lee).
C. Wetlands. Storms. Water. Lee.
D. The source says everything about wetlands is important.

11. When should a writer use quotation marks?

A. When using a source's exact words
B. Whenever writing a title of any paragraph
C. To show that every fact is uncertain
D. Instead of naming the source

12. Which action is plagiarism?

A. Summarizing a source and citing it
B. Submitting copied sentences as your own without credit
C. Using quotation marks around exact borrowed words
D. Writing an original explanation from your notes

13. Which is the strongest focused research question?

A. How does shade affect the growth of bean seedlings?
B. Are plants good?
C. What is everything about plants?
D. Why is the world interesting?

14. In an outline, what should supporting details do?

A. Repeat the same words without adding meaning
B. Replace the title and introduction
C. Introduce a different subject in every bullet
D. Explain or provide evidence for a main point

15. A report repeats the same fact in three paragraphs. What is the best revision?

A. Keep the fact where it is most useful and remove unnecessary repetitions.
B. Add the fact to two more paragraphs.
C. Replace every fact with an opinion.
D. Delete the main idea and keep the repetition.

16. Which sentence is edited correctly?

A. The children were excited because the museum had opened a new exhibit.
B. The children was excited because the museum had opened a new exhibit.
C. The children were excited because the museum have opened a new exhibit.
D. The children were excited becuase the museum had opened a new exhibit.

17. Which revision correctly fixes the run-on? “The rain stopped we went outside.”

A. The rain stopped, we went outside.
B. The rain stopped we, went outside.
C. The rain, stopped we went outside.
D. The rain stopped, and we went outside.

18. Which revision makes the fragment complete? “Although the path was steep.”

A. Because the path was steep.
B. When the path was steep.
C. Although the path was steep.
D. Although the path was steep, we continued climbing.

19. Which transition best links these ideas? “The first method saves water. ___, the second method costs less.”

A. First of all
B. For example
C. In contrast
D. As a result

20. A story's exciting moment feels rushed. What should the writer do?

A. Replace the event with a list of unrelated facts.
B. Add relevant actions, thoughts, or details to slow the scene.
C. Skip directly to the ending.
D. Remove all dialogue from the story.

21. What can dialogue help reveal in a narrative?

A. The spelling of every setting name
B. Only the story's page count
C. A character's thoughts, feelings, or relationships
D. The exact number of paragraphs

22. Which detail best shows that a character has become more responsible?

A. Dara walks past the classroom.
B. Dara likes the color green.
C. After forgetting once, Dara begins checking the class equipment list each day.
D. Dara owns two pencils.

23. Which detail most effectively establishes a setting in a mystery story?

A. The mystery is solved at the end.
B. The character is brave.
C. The narrator explains the lesson directly.
D. A clock ticked in the empty station while fog covered the platform.

24. Which sentence uses sensory details most effectively?

A. The kitchen was a room in a house.
B. The sharp scent of oranges filled the warm kitchen.
C. Oranges are sold in many markets.
D. The kitchen had been built years ago.

25. Which sentence is written in first-person point of view?

A. The visitor walked toward the door.
B. She held her breath as the door opened.
C. The door opened into a quiet room.
D. I held my breath as the door slowly opened.

26. Which conclusion best fits a report explaining how recycling reduces waste?

A. Recycling bins are sometimes round.
B. I once saw a truck near my home.
C. By sorting and reusing materials, communities can send less waste to landfills.
D. This report has several paragraphs.

27. Which structure best compares two animals?

A. List facts about animals without identifying them.
B. Tell a story unrelated to either animal.
C. Describe both animals' features, explaining similarities and differences.
D. Explain only one animal's life cycle.

28. Which sentence clearly explains a cause and its effect?

A. The soil was brown and the pot was round.
B. The gardener owned gloves and a shovel.
C. The seedlings were small, green, and quiet.
D. Because the soil was dry, the seedlings wilted.

29. Which sentence presents a problem and a solution?

A. Students enjoy recess on sunny days.
B. Litter filled the playground, so students organized a weekly cleanup.
C. The school building is made of brick.
D. The playground has swings and a slide.

30. Which revision uses a more precise verb? “The rabbit went across the garden.”

A. The rabbit got across the garden.
B. The rabbit did across the garden.
C. The rabbit was across the garden.
D. The rabbit darted across the garden.

31. Which sentence has the most appropriate formal tone for a report?

A. Everybody totally loves recess, no question.
B. The survey was kinda cool and stuff.
C. The survey results indicate that most students prefer outdoor recess.
D. The results are, like, whatever.

32. A writer is creating a safety poster for young children. Which approach is best?

A. Use long technical explanations with no examples.
B. Use short directions and clear, easy-to-understand wording.
C. Leave out the action readers should take.
D. Write only in complex sentences.

33. A peer says a paragraph has evidence but does not explain how it supports the claim. What should the writer add?

A. A sentence connecting the evidence to the claim
B. More evidence without any explanation
C. A second title that changes the topic
D. A decorative border around the page

34. Which topic sentence best fits details about recycling paper, metal, and glass?

A. Many everyday materials can be recycled instead of thrown away.
B. My family went shopping last week.
C. Paper is often used for writing.
D. Glass can break if it falls.

35. Which revision improves sentence variety?

A. We checked the garden and we checked the garden and we checked the garden.
B. The storm passed. The storm passed. The storm passed.
C. After the storm passed, we checked the garden. The fence had fallen, but the plants survived.
D. After the storm passed, after the storm passed, we checked.

36. Which transition best introduces a contrasting idea?

A. Similarly
B. For example
C. However
D. In addition

37. Which detail is least relevant to a paragraph arguing for safer school crossings?

A. An adult crossing guard can help students cross safely.
B. Clear crossing signs help drivers notice pedestrians.
C. Drivers should slow down near the school gate.
D. The school cafeteria serves soup on Fridays.

38. Why should a writer group notes under headings?

A. To make facts appear more reliable without checking them
B. To avoid deciding which details are important
C. To ensure every paragraph contains unrelated information
D. To sort related facts and make the report easier to organize

39. What information helps readers locate a source?

A. A personal guess about the source
B. Details such as the author's name, title, and publication information
C. The writer's favorite color
D. The number of pencils used to write the report

40. A draft has a weak claim and several spelling errors. What should the writer do first?

A. Change the font before improving the ideas.
B. Strengthen the claim and reasoning, then edit spelling.
C. Delete all supporting evidence.
D. Fix every spelling error and ignore the claim.

41. Which sentence is best suited to an informative report?

A. Mountains are the most exciting landforms.
B. Earth's surface includes landforms such as mountains, valleys, and plains.
C. Everyone should visit a mountain at least once.
D. Valleys are boring compared with plains.

42. What is the conflict in a story?

A. The problem or challenge the characters face
B. The number of words in the title
C. The list of sources at the end
D. The author's spelling choices

43. What does a resolution do in a story?

A. Explains the dictionary meaning of the title
B. Lists all the story's settings
C. Shows how the main problem is settled or changes
D. Introduces every character for the first time

44. Which conclusion best reinforces a claim that school gardens are worthwhile?

A. A school garden gives students a practical way to learn about plants and responsibility.
B. Some plants have green leaves.
C. Seeds are sold in small packets.
D. A garden may contain soil and stones.

45. Which sentence punctuates a quotation correctly?

A. “We should begin now” Omar, said.
B. “We should begin now”, Omar said.
C. “We should begin now,” Omar said.
D. We should begin now,” Omar said.

46. Which organizational structure explains how to complete a task?

A. Sequence of steps
B. Problem and solution only
C. Compare and contrast
D. Description of unrelated objects

47. A writer wants readers to take action to reduce plastic waste. Which purpose is this?

A. Persuasion
B. Narration only
C. Listing facts without a claim
D. Entertainment without a message

48. Which piece of evidence is strongest for a claim about school traffic safety?

A. A student's guess about the busiest street
B. A recent traffic study showing where near-school collisions occur
C. A photograph of an unrelated parking lot
D. A story about traffic in another country from long ago

49. A writer's draft has strong ideas but confusing paragraph order. What should happen next?

A. Submit the draft without revising.
B. Remove all supporting details.
C. Change the font size only.
D. Reorganize the paragraphs before checking small spelling errors.

50. Why should a writer consider the audience before choosing words?

A. Different readers may need different explanations and levels of detail.
B. Audience never affects how writing is presented.
C. A writer should always use the longest words available.
D. Every audience understands all technical terms.

Hard Questions

1. Which thesis is most focused and arguable?

A. Some students like sitting outside, and other students do not.
B. Our school should add shaded outdoor seating because it would improve comfort and make outdoor learning easier.
C. Outdoor spaces exist at many schools.
D. Shade is a word with several meanings.

2. A writer claims that later library hours would help students. Which evidence-reasoning pair is strongest?

A. The library is quiet, so it should open later without further explanation.
B. The library has blue signs, so later hours are necessary.
C. Some books are long, so all students need more hours.
D. Usage records show many students arrive just before closing; later hours would give them more time to study.

3. Which sentence fairly introduces a counterclaim to a proposal for longer recess?

A. Only careless people disagree with longer recess.
B. There is no possible reason to oppose longer recess.
C. Longer recess is obviously perfect.
D. Some teachers worry that longer recess could reduce class time.

4. Which rebuttal best answers the concern that longer recess reduces learning time?

A. Recess is fun, so no evidence is needed.
B. Teachers who disagree are wrong.
C. A short increase in recess may help students return to class more focused, while lessons can be planned efficiently.
D. Learning time does not matter.

5. Which evidence is most reliable for a report on household water use?

A. A recent report from a recognized water research agency
B. A product advertisement making unsupported claims
C. An anonymous online post with no sources
D. A fictional story about a drought

6. Two sources give different numbers for annual rainfall. What should the writer do first?

A. Check their dates, methods, locations, and original data.
B. Average the numbers without checking what they measure.
C. Choose whichever number is larger.
D. Use both numbers without explaining the difference.

7. Which option is an acceptable paraphrase of a source's idea?

A. The source explains that wetlands can store stormwater and reduce flooding (Lee).
B. Wetlands store stormwater and reduce flooding, and that proves all wetlands are identical.
C. Wetlands can store stormwater and reduce flooding. (exact source sentence copied with no credit)
D. Lee's article is interesting because it mentions wetlands.

8. Which sentence integrates a quotation most smoothly?

A. The report says plastic. “Can remain.” In the environment for decades.
B. Plastic can remain in the environment for decades” the report says.
C. “Plastic can remain in the environment for decades.” This is the report. It is important.
D. The report warns that “plastic can remain in the environment for decades,” emphasizing the need to reduce waste.

9. A student changes a few words from a source but keeps its sentence structure and gives no credit. Why is this still a problem?

A. The idea and wording pattern are borrowed without proper attribution.
B. Changing words always makes a passage a direct quotation.
C. Any use of research is forbidden.
D. Only images can be plagiarized.

10. Which question is most suitable for a short research report with evidence?

A. What is the complete history of every insect?
B. Are flowers nice?
C. How does planting native flowers affect the number of pollinators in a school garden?
D. Why does nature exist?

11. Which outline is best organized for an informative report on solar energy?

A. Conclusion; unrelated biography; benefits; title
B. Three repeated headings with no supporting details
C. How solar panels work; benefits; limitations; conclusion
D. Benefits; conclusion; a list of favorite colors; how panels work

12. A report jumps from school gardens to ocean pollution and then to sports. What revision would most improve cohesion?

A. Repeat the title at the end of every paragraph.
B. Add more unrelated topics between each section.
C. Group related ideas into sections and remove or relocate details that do not support the report's focus.
D. Keep the order but remove all transitions.

13. A paragraph states that public parks benefit communities but offers no explanation. What should be added?

A. Specific examples and facts showing how parks support recreation, health, or community events.
B. A longer title with no new information
C. A repeated copy of the topic sentence
D. Several unrelated facts about the writer

14. Which sequence best explains how to conduct a simple plant-growth investigation?

A. Publish results before testing, then decide what was measured.
B. Ask a question, plan a fair test, record observations, compare results, draw a conclusion.
C. Draw a conclusion, change the question, ignore results, then begin.
D. Record a conclusion, select random conditions, then skip observations.

15. A climactic scene is meant to feel tense. Which revision best supports that goal?

A. Remove the character's actions and jump to the next day.
B. Slow the moment with focused actions, brief thoughts, and carefully chosen details.
C. Summarize the entire scene in one unrelated sentence.
D. Insert a long explanation about an unrelated character.

16. Which dialogue revision best reveals tension without directly explaining it?

A. “I am angry and tense,” Nia said, explaining the entire emotion.
B. “You promised you'd be here,” Nia said, folding the note into smaller and smaller squares.
C. “Hello,” Nia said. “The weather is pleasant.”
D. Nia spoke words that were words of speech.

17. Which detail most clearly reveals why a character returns a lost wallet?

A. The office has a desk and two chairs.
B. Although she needs money, Ayo takes the wallet to the office because she knows its owner will be worried.
C. Ayo notices that the wallet is brown.
D. The wallet contains several cards.

18. How does first-person narration differ from third-person narration?

A. First-person cannot include dialogue, while third-person can.
B. Third-person always reveals every character's thoughts.
C. First-person uses a narrator who refers to themself as “I”; third-person refers to characters as “he,” “she,” or “they.”
D. First-person must be nonfiction, while third-person must be fiction.

19. Which detail best develops a theme about perseverance?

A. The room has a square window.
B. After several failed attempts, the character studies each mistake and finally completes the difficult design.
C. The character buys a new notebook.
D. The design is drawn with a blue pen.

20. Which setting detail best creates an uneasy mood?

A. The hallway was built near the main entrance.
B. The room had four walls and a ceiling.
C. A loose shutter tapped in the dark while footsteps echoed in the empty hall.
D. The building opened at eight each morning.

21. Which sentence uses personification to establish mood?

A. The playground had two swings.
B. The sun set behind the buildings.
C. The shadows were long.
D. The shadows crept across the abandoned playground.

22. Which revision is most concise without losing meaning? “Due to the fact that it was raining, the match was delayed.”

A. The match, which was a match, was delayed because of the rain situation.
B. In view of the fact that rain was falling from the sky, the match was delayed.
C. It was raining rain, and for that reason the match had a delay.
D. Because it was raining, the match was delayed.

23. Which sentence best fits a formal science report?

A. The plants were kind of, like, taller or something.
B. Those plants were doing awesome stuff.
C. The seedlings totally got way bigger in the bright spot.
D. The observations suggest that seedlings exposed to more light grew taller.

24. Which revision combines the ideas most clearly? “The river rose. Heavy rain fell overnight.”

A. The river, heavy rain fell overnight, rose.
B. After heavy rain fell overnight, the river rose.
C. The river rose, and heavy rain fell overnight before the river rose, and it rose.
D. The river rose heavy rain fell overnight.

25. Which sentence uses parallel structure?

A. The club plans to collect cans, sort paper, and plant trees.
B. The club plans collecting cans, to sort paper, and trees are planted.
C. The club plans to collect cans, sorting paper, and planting trees.
D. The club plans cans, to sort paper, and trees.

26. Which transition best completes the argument? “The new crossing would cost money. ___, it could prevent dangerous accidents.”

A. Nevertheless
B. In the same way
C. Similarly
D. For example

27. Which conclusion is strongest for an essay supporting a school compost program?

A. A compost program can reduce food waste and help students learn how discarded materials can become useful soil.
B. The cafeteria serves lunch each school day.
C. Compost is a word that can be found in a dictionary.
D. Some students have seen gardens in the past.

28. Which claim is most reasonable and specific?

A. Reading is the only skill anyone needs.
B. All books are better than every other activity.
C. Every student hates reading without a daily period.
D. A ten-minute daily reading period could help many students build reading habits.

29. A student argues that a new playground is popular using one friend's opinion. What is the best improvement?

A. Claim the playground is popular without more evidence.
B. Use an unrelated statistic about rainfall.
C. Repeat the friend's opinion several times.
D. Gather feedback from a wider range of students using a fair survey.

30. A website gives a surprising statistic but names no source. What should the writer do?

A. Include it because surprising facts are always true.
B. Change the number to make it seem more believable.
C. Cite the website without checking the claim.
D. Find a credible source that verifies the statistic before using it.

31. Why should a research report include citations?

A. They replace the need to organize ideas.
B. They make every claim automatically true.
C. They credit original sources and let readers trace the information.
D. They show that the writer did not form any ideas.

32. Two sources agree that trees cool streets but explain different reasons. What should the writer do?

A. Place unrelated details from each source in the conclusion.
B. Copy both sources in full without explanation.
C. Ignore one source because differences are always mistakes.
D. Combine the relevant ideas and explain how the sources complement each other.

33. Which feedback most directly helps improve reasoning?

A. Use a larger font for the heading.
B. Change the paper to a different color.
C. Add a decorative image to every paragraph.
D. Explain how the statistic supports your claim, and add a link between the evidence and your conclusion.

34. Which sentence is grammatically correct?

A. Neither the coach nor the players be ready to leave.
B. Neither the coach nor the players was ready to leave. (plural subject nearest verb)
C. Neither the coach nor the players were ready to leave.
D. Neither the coach or the players were ready to leave.

35. Which sentence correctly punctuates two independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction?

A. The clouds, gathered but the match continued.
B. The clouds gathered, but the match continued.
C. The clouds gathered, the match continued.
D. The clouds gathered but, the match continued.

36. Which revision corrects the fragment “When the lights went out.”?

A. When the lights went out.
B. After the lights went out, and.
C. Because the lights went out.
D. When the lights went out, everyone waited quietly.

37. Which revision correctly fixes this run-on? “The team practiced hard they won the final.”

A. The team practiced hard so, they won the final.
B. The team practiced hard, they won the final.
C. The team practiced hard, so they won the final.
D. The team practiced hard they, won the final.

38. A serious report suddenly includes slang and jokes. What should the writer do?

A. Revise the informal language so the tone remains appropriate for the report's purpose and audience.
B. Change the title but leave the tone unchanged.
C. Add more jokes to every paragraph.
D. Remove all facts and use opinions instead.

39. A report for younger students uses technical terms. What is the best revision?

A. Explain necessary terms in simple language and provide clear examples.
B. Remove every important idea from the report.
C. Keep all terms unexplained to sound expert.
D. Replace the facts with jokes only.

40. Which detail best supports a description of a crowded market?

A. The writer has visited a market before.
B. Vendors called out prices as shoppers squeezed past baskets of ripe mangoes.
C. A market is a place to buy goods.
D. Markets are found in many cities.

41. Which ending most effectively resolves a story about a team that disagrees over a project?

A. The project had a title.
B. After listening to each idea, the team combined their plans and presented a design everyone had helped create.
C. The team met in a classroom.
D. One student owned a pencil.

42. Which statement best combines a claim and a reason?

A. Some bottles have narrow openings.
B. The school should provide refill stations because they can reduce single-use plastic bottles.
C. Refill stations are made of different materials.
D. Plastic is used to make many objects.

43. Which sentence acknowledges an opposing view fairly?

A. Although printed worksheets are convenient, digital assignments can reduce paper use when students have reliable access to devices.
B. Digital assignments have no disadvantages.
C. Printed worksheets are always useless.
D. Anyone who likes paper is wrong.

44. Which revision replaces the vague phrase “things got better”?

A. Things were much better in many ways.
B. Attendance increased and fewer students arrived late.
C. A lot of stuff happened differently.
D. It was better and good for everyone.

45. Which sentence has correct spelling and punctuation?

A. The committee discussed its plan then, shared the results.
B. The committee discussed its plan, then shared the results.
C. The committee discused its plan, then shared the results.
D. The commitee discussed it's plan then shared the results.

46. A writer receives feedback that the evidence is weak. What should happen next?

A. Delete the entire report without reviewing it.
B. Proofread commas only and submit the unchanged draft.
C. Revisit the sources, strengthen the evidence, and revise the relevant paragraphs.
D. Ignore the feedback and only change the font.

47. Before publishing a final report, which step is most appropriate?

A. Leave visible editing notes in the middle of the report.
B. Add unverified facts to make the report longer.
C. Check that the content is accurate, the format is readable, and citations are included.
D. Remove all headings even if they help readers.

48. Which evidence best supports a proposal to add more recycling bins at school?

A. A waste audit shows that many recyclable bottles are currently thrown into general bins.
B. The bins could be painted several colors.
C. A nearby shop sells paper products.
D. One student says recycling is interesting.

49. A conclusion introduces a new claim that the essay never discusses. What is the best revision?

A. Remove the new claim or develop it earlier with relevant reasons and evidence.
B. Keep it because conclusions should surprise readers.
C. Replace the conclusion with a list of spelling corrections.
D. Add unrelated facts to the introduction.

50. One source explains the benefits of school gardens; another describes the costs. How should a balanced report use them?

A. Ignore costs because they complicate the topic.
B. Copy both sources without explaining their relationship.
C. Present relevant benefits and costs, then explain what the evidence suggests overall.
D. Use only the source that agrees with the writer's preference.

Answer Key

Answer letters correspond to the final randomized option order in each difficulty section.

Easy

1. C 2. C 3. C 4. D 5. C 6. D 7. B 8. B 9. B 10. A
11. C 12. C 13. A 14. C 15. A 16. A 17. A 18. D 19. D 20. C
21. A 22. C 23. A 24. D 25. B 26. D 27. B 28. D 29. D 30. C
31. A 32. B 33. B 34. B 35. A 36. B 37. C 38. A 39. C 40. A
41. D 42. B 43. D 44. A 45. B 46. D 47. B 48. B 49. A 50. D

Medium

1. B 2. D 3. A 4. B 5. A 6. C 7. C 8. D 9. B 10. B
11. A 12. B 13. A 14. D 15. A 16. A 17. D 18. D 19. C 20. B
21. C 22. C 23. D 24. B 25. D 26. C 27. C 28. D 29. B 30. D
31. C 32. B 33. A 34. A 35. C 36. C 37. D 38. D 39. B 40. B
41. B 42. A 43. C 44. A 45. C 46. A 47. A 48. B 49. D 50. A

Hard

1. B 2. D 3. D 4. C 5. A 6. A 7. A 8. D 9. A 10. C
11. C 12. C 13. A 14. B 15. B 16. B 17. B 18. C 19. B 20. C
21. D 22. D 23. D 24. B 25. A 26. A 27. A 28. D 29. D 30. D
31. C 32. D 33. D 34. C 35. B 36. D 37. C 38. A 39. A 40. B
41. B 42. B 43. A 44. B 45. B 46. C 47. C 48. A 49. A 50. C